

Grammar Judge Report

Generated on 16 April 2026, 17:24 | Student Level: F2

Models in use (discovered at runtime): gemini-2.5-flash, gpt-4.1-mini, gpt-4.1-nano | Presiding judge: gemini-2.5-flash

Case Details

Instruction / Question Type	Read the passage about a class project and fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verb in the brackets.
Question Item	In fact, they (7)_____ (already / win) two design awards for the school this year.
Expected Answer	have already won
Student's Answer	already have won

Final Verdict Summary

LENIENT	STRICT
ACCEPT	REJECT

Lenient: The student's answer 'already have won' clearly conveys the intended meaning and demonstrates a fundamental understanding of the present perfect tense, including the correct auxiliary verb and past participle. While the placement of 'already' is not the most standard, it is a common variation, especially at this F2 level, and does not impede communication. Therefore, in a lenient assessment, the answer is acceptable.

Strict: Under strict grammatical rules for formal English, the adverb 'already' in the present perfect tense should be placed between the auxiliary verb 'have' and the main verb 'won'. The student's placement of 'already' before 'have' constitutes a grammatical error in word order. Consequently, for a strict evaluation adhering to prescriptive grammar, the answer must be rejected.

Judge's Note to Teacher: For marking, consider awarding partial credit to acknowledge the student's grasp of the tense and verb forms. In class, gently correct the word order, explaining the standard placement of adverbs like 'already' within the present perfect structure, perhaps by contrasting it with more informal usage.

Jury Opinions

Juror 1: gemini-2.5-flash	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT
A rigorous academic grammarian who applies formal prescriptive grammar rules.	Lenient: While the placement of 'already' is not the most common or stylistically preferred in formal English, it does not fundamentally alter the meaning or create ambiguity. The student has correctly identified the tense (present perfect) and the correct forms of the auxiliary and main verbs. Strict: According to prescriptive grammar rules for adverbs of frequency or time like 'already' in the present perfect tense, the adverb should typically be placed between the auxiliary verb ('have') and the main verb ('won'). The student's placement of 'already' before 'have' is grammatically incorrect in formal written English, even though it might be heard in very informal speech.
Juror 2: gpt-4.1-mini	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT
An experienced HKDSE and school exam marker who applies marking schemes pragmatically and fairly.	Lenient: The student's answer 'already have won' conveys the intended meaning clearly and the auxiliary verb 'have' is present, showing understanding of the present perfect tense. Minor word order issues are common at this level and do not impede comprehension. Strict: The correct word order for present perfect with an adverb like 'already' is 'have already won.' Placing 'already' before 'have' is grammatically incorrect in standard English, so this answer does not meet formal grammar standards.
Juror 3: gpt-4.1-nano	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT
An EFL/ESL specialist with deep experience in Hong Kong secondary school English education, sensitive to common learner errors and local curriculum expectations.	Lenient: The phrase 'already have won' is understandable and closely resembles the correct present perfect tense 'have already won.' Given the student's level, this minor error may be forgiven as a common mistake, especially in spoken or informal contexts. Strict: The correct grammatical form is 'have already won,' with 'have' as the auxiliary verb preceding the past participle. Placing 'already' after 'have' disrupts the standard word order of the present perfect tense, making the answer grammatically incorrect under formal standards.
Juror 4: gemini-2.5-flash (Descriptive Linguist)	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT
A descriptive linguist who judges acceptability based on contemporary educated usage rather than textbook rules.	Lenient: While 'already' typically precedes 'have' in the present perfect, placing it after 'have' is a common and understandable variation in spoken and informal English. The meaning is clear, and it demonstrates an understanding of the present perfect tense. Strict: In formal written English, the adverb 'already' should generally be placed between the auxiliary verb 'have' and the past participle 'won' in the present perfect tense. The student's placement of 'already' after 'have' deviates from this standard grammatical structure.

Juror 5: gpt-4.1-mini (Communicative Specialist) A communicative language teaching specialist who values meaning and functional accuracy above rigid formal correctness.	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT Lenient: The student's answer 'already have won' conveys the intended meaning clearly and is understandable in context. For a secondary school F2 student, this word order mistake does not impede communication and shows partial grasp of the present perfect tense. Strict: The correct word order for present perfect with 'already' is 'have already won.' The student's placement of 'already' before 'have' is grammatically incorrect in standard English and does not conform to formal grammar rules.
Juror 6: gpt-4.1-nano (Conservative Marker) A conservative marker who prioritises grammatical precision and penalises ambiguity or borderline answers.	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT Lenient: The phrase 'already have won' is understandable and commonly used in informal contexts, and the meaning is clear. Given the student's level, this minor deviation from the standard order may be tolerated as a colloquial variation. Strict: According to strict grammatical rules, the correct form is 'have already won,' with the auxiliary verb 'have' preceding 'already.' The student's answer reverses this order, which is incorrect in formal and standard English grammar.
Juror 7: gemini-2.5-flash (Broad-minded Educator) A broad-minded language educator who considers both communicative effectiveness and grammatical accuracy.	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT Lenient: The student has correctly identified the tense (present perfect) and the auxiliary verb 'have' along with the past participle 'won'. The placement of 'already' before 'have' is a common error, but it does not significantly impede understanding. For an F2 student, demonstrating an understanding of the present perfect tense is the primary goal. Strict: Under strict grammatical rules, adverbs like 'already' should typically be placed between the auxiliary verb and the main verb in the present perfect tense (e.g., 'have already won'). The student's placement of 'already' before 'have' is grammatically incorrect, even though the meaning is still conveyed.
Juror 8: gpt-4.1-mini (Corpus Linguist) A corpus linguist who bases judgements on frequency and attested usage patterns in real-world English corpora.	Lenient: ACCEPT Strict: REJECT Lenient: The student's answer 'already have won' is understandable and the meaning is clear. Although the adverb 'already' is not in the most typical position, this word order can occasionally occur in spoken or informal English, so leniently it can be accepted. Strict: Under strict formal grammar standards, the correct placement of the adverb 'already' in the present perfect tense is before the past participle, as in 'have already won.' The student's word order 'already have won' is not standard and would be considered incorrect in formal writing.

**Juror 9: gpt-4.1-nano
(Learner Advocate)**

Lenient: **ACCEPT** Strict: **REJECT**

A learner advocate who considers the student's developmental stage and gives credit for partial mastery of grammatical structures.

Lenient: The student's answer 'already have won' conveys the correct meaning and is understandable in context. Given the student's developmental stage, this form shows a good grasp of the present perfect tense, and minor errors can be overlooked with leniency.

Strict: According to strict grammatical rules, the correct form should be 'have already won' with 'have' preceding 'already,' as the auxiliary verb comes before the adverb in present perfect constructions. The student's answer does not follow this standard word order.